Communication Styles

Warm-up Questions:

How often do you have miscommunication at work? What do you think is the reason?
Have you ever had difficulties communicating with a foreign coworker?
What is the worst communication problem you've ever experienced with your boss?

Expressions: Clarifying and confirming

I'm sorry… Excuse me…

I didn't catch that. I couldn't hear you. I don't understand.
I am not sure what you mean. Correct me, if I'm wrong… Just to be clear.

Could you repeat that? Could you say that again?
Could you speak slower? Could you elaborate on that?
Could you go over that again? Could you clarify what you mean?
Could you rephrase that? What exactly do you mean by…?
Do you mean…? So, what you are saying is…?

6 Tips to being a better listener and a communicator:

1. Show empathy
2. Instead of "You" use "I" statements
3. Mirror and repeat back what the other person is saying
4. Ask open-ended questions
5. Monitor your nonverbal communication
6. Practice humility

Which tip do you think is the most useful? Least useful?
Do you use any of the tips from the above?
Do you know other tips on being a better communicator and a listener?